

Hongji Pu

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RESEARCH FOCUS

My research focuses on building reliable and adaptive LLM systems under uncertainty. I study how language models can use structured evidence, model profiles, rubrics, and reusable skills to improve routing, retrieval, evaluation, and agentic decision-making. Across these directions, my work aims to move LLM systems beyond static prompting toward feedback-driven systems that can reason, self-improve, and generalize to new tasks, domains, and models.

EDUCATION

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|-----------|--|
| 2025-2027 | M.S. in Financial Engineering
Grainger College of Engineering, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign
<i>Advisor: Prof. Jiaxuan You</i>
<i>Advisor: Prof. Liming Feng</i> |
| 2021-2025 | B.S. in Finance
Central University of Finance and Economics
<i>Advisor: Yangdi Zhu</i> |

PUBLICATIONS

Manuscripts and Preprints

* denotes equal contribution

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|------|---|
| 2026 | GapForge: Paper-Grounded Continual Self-Evolving System for Language Models
Hongji Pu , Yilun Zhao, Wenpeng Yin
<i>Manuscript in preparation of ICLR 2027</i> |
| 2026 | BelifRAG: Uncertainty-Aware Retrieval as Information Acquisition
Hongji Pu , Boyu Zheng, Zihan Wang, Hang Li, Jiliang Tang
<i>Manuscript in preparation of ICLR 2027</i> |
| 2026 | ScoreFlow: Modeling Automatic Scoring as Rubric-System Optimization
Hongji Pu , Hang Li, Jiliang Tang
<i>Manuscript in preparation for submission of AAAI 2026</i> |
| 2026 | SkillOps: Managing LLM Agent Skill Libraries as Self-Maintaining Software Ecosystems
Hongji Pu , Xinyuan Song
<i>Manuscript in preparation for submission of AAAI 2026</i> |
| 2026 | RouteProfile: Elucidating the Design Space of LLM Profiles for Routing.
Jingjun Xu*, Hongji Pu *, Tao Feng*, Haozhen Zhang, Jiaxuan You, and Ge Liu
<i>In Submission of COLM 2026</i> |
| 2026 | Beyond Forecasting: Recasting Volatility Control as a Routing Problem
Hongji Pu , Leyang Zhou, Liming Feng
<i>Manuscript in preparation for submission of ACM ICAIF 2026</i> |
| 2025 | Memory as Coordination: Rethinking Communication in Multi-Agent Reinforcement Learning
Hongji Pu , Wei Duan, Jie Lu
<i>In Submission of ACL 2026</i> |